

getting an interview with Mr. Kaufman, I thought I'd check in with Mr. Crawford. In fact, after seeing the blurb in the magazine, I phoned him immediately.

What impressed me the most in the article was that Mr. Crawford apparently had been specific. Other forecasters that I'd been following tried to avoid specificity with words such as *likely*, *scenario*, or *within a context*, but Mr. Crawford not only picked the exact week the market would drop, but also the size of the drop.

The astrologer agreed to meet me at his favorite coffee shop, but then he didn't show up. I called back, and he said I must have gotten the date wrong. I insisted he'd gotten the date wrong, which is a very dangerous thing for an astrologer to do. Anyway, we rescheduled.

He arrived in his same blue cotton shirt and corduroy pants, same thick glasses with tortoise-shell rims, same reddish hair and Appalachian complexion, same overall look of the underpaid professor on sabbatical. Again he ordered tea with no caffeine.

I congratulated him about the wonderful prediction, and said I wished I'd known about it earlier. He said I had known about it earlier. He reminded me he'd been sending me his newsletter, *Crawford Perspectives*, since our earlier meeting. It was the two-page mimeographed job I'd apparently been throwing out with the junk mail.

"With all the other stuff I've had to read," I apologized, "I guess yours got lost in the pile." That I'd held his prediction right in my hands without knowing it was a sad realization. Mr. Crawford tried to cheer me up by offering to run to his apartment, which doubled as his office, to get me another copy. I offered to run along with him so I could see his workplace. He refused, just as he had the last time we'd met, insisting that the place was still messy. In a few minutes, Mr. Crawford returned with his issue of August 30, 1986, typewritten and mimeographed on drab gray paper. The headline read:

SHORT-TERM SELL THIS WEEK!!

LONG-TERM SELL STILL OPERATIVE!!

The text below described a dangerous "massive rolling top formation" and the general sorry state of the markets. "The public